HOORVIA - GIT MERGE VS REBASE CHEAT SHEET: PRINTABLE COMMAND GUIDE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Tech & Software · Sheet #1

Topic	Merge	Rebase
What it does	Joins two branch histories with a merge commit	Replays your commits onto the target branch tip
History shape	True history - branchy, every commit kept	Linear history - reads as one straight line
Update a feature branch	git merge main	git rebase main
Finish a feature	Merge the branch into main	Rebase onto main, then fast-forward merge
Resolve conflicts	Fix files, stage, git commit	Fix files, stage, git rebase --continue
Abort midway	git merge --abort	git rebase --abort
Pull updates	git pull (merges by default)	git pull --rebase
Push after rewriting	Normal push works	git push --force-with-lease
Edit old commits	Not available	git rebase -i HEAD~3 (squash, reword, drop)
Golden rule	Safe on shared branches	Never rebase commits others have pulled
Best for	Public branches and team collaboration	Private branches before a pull request
Readability	Shows exactly what happened	Clean story, hides the trial and error

PRO TIP: Rebase Before the Pull Request: Clean your private branch with git rebase -i so reviewers read a tidy story, not your debugging trail.